DESIGNING SPACES THAT GROW

Moving away from chaotic, themed rooms, children's spaces now embrace serenity, flexibility and independent play

By SALONI VAID

We spend a small fortune on parenthood trying to get the little things right, yet designing a child's sanctuary often leaves parents thoroughly bewildered. The key, according to experts, is to shift from rigid, thematic clutter towards adaptable environments that allow children to naturally colonise the space on their own terms. "We design knowing that children will almost always use spaces and objects in ways we could never have imagined. That's one of the joys of designing for childhood," says Rubah Musvee, architect, mother and founder of Lila, a kid's furniture studio.

